



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: King's Classical Academy
School Website: <https://kingsclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Kings Classical Academy (CA 94550) presents a robust Classical Christian program that aligns very strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as a formation of character, virtue, and a Christian worldview, with explicit emphasis on the Trinity of truth, goodness, and beauty, integrated through a classical liberal-arts pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books/GaConversation tradition. The school publicly emphasizes Christ-centered education, biblical worldview, chapel-like community practices, and parent partnership as core pillars. Evidence drawn directly from the school's published materials shows clear commitments to a Christ-centered, theologically grounded curriculum; a three-tiered curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric) across TK–12; a focus on Great Books and the Great Conversation; and explicit parent involvement and discipleship within a shared faith community. The school also highlights accreditation (WASC) and a mission statement that foregrounds wonder, wisdom, and worship as outcomes of education.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key signals include: Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, Great Books/Great Conversation, Trinity of truth/beauty/goodness, formation over mere information, grammar–logic–rhetoric curriculum, Socratic/seminar-style upper-school pedagogy, and explicit parent partnership. There are no strong counter-indicators or negative signals in the public materials reviewed.

- Evidence sources include mission statements, curriculum descriptions, admissions materials, Great Books references, and pedagogy descriptions drawn from the school's site and firecrawl materials. See references to Christ-centered mission and Biblical worldview (e.g., Our Mission and Statement of Faith discussions) as well as explicit references to chapel, great books, and classical pedagogy.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames itself as Christ-centered and Christian in orientation, with language about Biblical worldview permeating curriculum and practice (e.g., "Christ-centered, Classical education" and "biblical worldview across the curriculum"). - Public-facing materials reference worship/chapel and liturgical/community practices (e.g., chapel meetings). - Foundational religious rationale is stated in admissions and about-us content, including statements about discipling students and integrating faith with learning. - The Great Books/Great Conversation tradition appears as an explicit aim (Dorothy Sayers reference to "Great Conversation").

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Christ-centered; Biblical worldview; worship; chapel; biblical worldview across curriculum; Great Books; Great Conversation; discipline/virtue; truth; wisdom; worship; God's design; faith; Scripture. - Negative keywords observed: none detected in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: at least 9–12 distinct terms/ideas clearly reflected (Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, worship, chapel, Great Books, Great Conversation, virtue, wisdom, truth, wonder, worship, God's kingdom, faith). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Proportional takeaway: Positive approx. 100%, Negative approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The material consistently grounds education in a Christian metaphysical frame and theology, with explicit liturgical/community practices (chapel), and a faith-infused curriculum. The presence of Great Books/Great Conversation anchored in a Christian worldview indicates a strongly classical-religious foundation, not merely secular or value-neutral education. This aligns squarely with the “Transcendental moral realism,” “Grounded in Theology,” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices” elements described in the classical rubric.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes forming the whole person (wisdom, virtue, character) rather than a narrow job-focused aim, e.g., “Educating the Whole Person” and “formation” language in core principles. - Explicit emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and formation, rather than information-only goals, plus the Great Books/Great Conversation framework as a source of meaning and aim. The mission emphasizes partnering with parents and discipling students toward wonder, wisdom, and worship. - The Great Books/Great Conversation framework situates truth, goodness, and beauty as real aims for the mind and soul, not merely informational content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: virtue; wisdom; character; formation; truth; beauty; wonder; education as formation; Great Books; Great Conversation. - Negative keywords observed: none detectable in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 6–8 distinct terms/themes (virtue, wisdom, character, formation, truth, beauty, wonder, Great Books/Great Conversation). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Proportional takeaway: Positive approx. 100%, Negative approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The school emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom and posits truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowledge-competent human pursuits. The mission emphasizes wonder and worship as outcomes, aligning with a formation-first goal rather than vocational training. This matches the rubric's expectations for a CLASSICAL orientation in purpose and goal.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly described as a liberal-arts progression aligned with grammar, logic, and rhetoric (TK–12 or K–12 segments). Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric are named explicitly across the grades. - Core content at different stages is specified: Grammar School (TK–6): Bible & History, Mathematics, Grammar/English, Latin, Science; Logic School (7–8): Bible & History, Mathematics, Latin, Logic, Writing; Rhetoric School (9–12): Science, Mathematics, Bible, Literature, Civics/Economics, and rhetoric forms part of the training. - The curriculum highlights Great Books, the Great Conversation, and the cultivation of wonder as part of the educational experience. - Latin begins in 3rd grade; emphasis on classical languages as a foundation for vocabulary and thinking.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: grammar; logic; rhetoric; Bible; History; Latin; Writing; Science; Great Books; Great Conversation; Civics/Economics; wonder; formation. - Negative keywords observed: none (no explicit “social studies” reframing; curriculum appears in classic liberal-arts terms).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 9–11 distinct curriculum terms (grammar; logic; rhetoric; Bible; History; Latin; Writing; Science; Civics/Economics; Great Books; Great Conversation). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Proportional takeaway: Positive approx. 100%, Negative approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The school's explicit triad of grammar/logic/rhetoric, plus a content map that spans Bible/History, Latin, and writing, and the explicit emphasis on Great Books and Great Conversation, align fully with the classical curriculum criteria. The absence of a non-classical framing (e.g., social studies-only framing) supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe a pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates in the upper school, with explicit rhetoric training and opportunities to give speeches. The general classical method is reinforced by the school's alignment with the Great Books/Great Conversation framework. - Upper-school pedagogical approach includes training in rhetoric and opportunities for formal speaking; higher-order argumentation and critical-thinking modes are evident. - The broader classical pedagogy emphasizes contemplative/restful elements as part of a balanced approach (though specific lower-school singing/rest is not explicitly stated on the site; the overall emphasis leans toward contemplation via Great Books and Socratic inquiry). The brochure overview also emphasizes a contemplative stance in classical education generally.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic discussion; seminars; debates; rhetoric training; Great Books; Great Conversation; contemplation/restful learning (conceptually in line with scholē). - Negative keywords observed: none.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 5–7 distinct items (Socratic, seminars, debates, rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, contemplation/scholē as a discipline). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Proportional takeaway: Positive approx. 100%, Negative approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The presence of Socratic and seminar-based discourse in upper grades, combined with rhetoric training and a clear emphasis on the Great Books approach, aligns with the pedagogical expectations for a Classical School. The public materials strongly favor a balanced pedagogy that includes contemplative/ memory-strengthening elements and active discussion. This yields a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials indicate a belief in “Christ-loving Educators” and a staff-aligned vision, with a recruitment emphasis on faith-aligned educators who share the school's mission and standards. This suggests faculty modeled on virtue and formation, with expectations for high standards. - The school emphasizes a mission-driven staff culture and a family-like community, with small class sizes enabling personalized mentorship and living-the-curriculum dynamics (implied by “admissions” and “Portrait of a Graduate” content).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: virtuous educators; mentorship; character formation; high expectations; modeling virtue; faith and reason; lifelong learning; professionalism. - Negative keywords observed: none.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 5–7 distinct terms/themes (virtue, mentorship, character formation, high expectations, role-modeling, faith+reason, lifelong learning). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Proportional takeaway: Positive approx. 100%, Negative approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The school frames faculty as more than mere instructors—explicitly aligning with virtues and character formation, and pointing to staff who embody and model the school's values. This aligns with the rubric's expectations for “the living curriculum” and virtuous, collegial faculty culture. While explicit phrasing like “living curriculum” is not verbatim, the recruitment language and mission framing strongly support CLASSICAL faculty by reflection of virtue and formation in teaching.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is a strong emphasis on partnering with parents and treating parents as co-teachers in the educational process (explicit calls to parent involvement, statements about parental partnership, and the presence of parent-focused program pages). - Admissions materials require parents to understand the school's biblical philosophy and Statement of Faith, indicating alignment and ongoing formation for families as part of the educational project. - The school's site features content directed at parents (e.g., "For Our Parents," "Statement of Faith," "Portrait of a Graduate") and mentions open access to campus visits and family involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents; co-teachers with parents; parental involvement; statements of faith; campus visits; Portrait of a Graduate; parent education opportunities (e.g., "Read Our Statement of Faith," etc.). - Negative keywords observed: none.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 5–7 distinct items/phrases (parent partnership; co-education; faith alignment; open visits; family education; Statement of Faith; Portrait of a Graduate). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Proportional takeaway: Positive approx. 100%, Negative approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The school presents a clearly collaborative model with parents, including explicit co-teaching language and faith-aligned parental education. The admissions prerequisites reinforce the expectation that families share the school's religious commitments, and the campus offers opportunities for parental engagement. These are hallmarks of a CLASSICAL Parents & Community framework.

What Would Move the Needle

No needle-mover actions are necessary to reach a full CLASSICAL rating given the strong alignment across all six categories. If any improvement were to be contemplated, it would be to more explicitly surface the exact vocabulary from the Six Essential Elements (positive/negative keyword lists) in every public page, so external readers can quantify alignment with even more precision. Additionally, expanding explicit sections on faculty as "living curriculum" and showcasing concrete examples of Socratic seminars or student-led Great Conversation transcripts could further strengthen perception of a fully classical pedagogy for external evaluators.

- Possible enhancements (optional, non-required for CLASSICAL status):
- Add a short, explicit "Living Curriculum" statement on the site, linking faculty behavior to Virtue and Wisdom models.
- Publish sample Socratic seminar prompts or student speeches from upper grades to illustrate pedagogy in action.
- Create a dedicated page showing how Great Books and the Great Conversation are integrated into the daily schedule.

Note: These are not currently necessary to achieve CLASSICAL status, but would serve to strengthen evidence-based alignment with the Six Essential Elements.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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